



Muncie Redevelopment Commission August 18, 2022

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SJ2FI5h-bk
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Target Category	muncie_city

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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting was called to order by the presiding officer [00:00:15](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Commission Miller, Commission Pravela, Commission Tomlin, Commission Wagley, and the presiding officer (Mr. Lowe).
 - **Absent:** None noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Mr. Lowe.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Not mentioned in the transcript.
- **Approval of Minutes:** The board reviewed the minutes from the previous meeting (noting some initial delivery issues). Upon motion and second, the minutes were **Approved by Voice Vote** following a roll call acknowledgment of ayes (Miller, Pravela, Tomlin, Wagley, and Lowe) [00:01:03](#).

Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:01:23 Review and Approval of Claims**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Wright.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Wright presented minimal claims, which included bond administration payments to Bose, McKinney, and Evans; LWG CPAs and Advisors; and Beasley Gilkeson. A brief inquiry was made regarding village parking garage fund expenses.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Miller, Pravela, Tomlin, Wagley, and Lowe all voting yes).
- **00:03:04 Mayor's Report & Project Updates**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** The Mayor (and Deputy Mayor Richard Ivey).
 - **Deliberation Summary:**
 - *Riverbend Apartments:* 60 new apartment units at Memorial and Burlington nearing exterior completion in a TIF district. Noted that Pizza King bought a building across the street. Mentioned a planned canoe/kayak launch (Project Blue Ways) behind the apartments.
 - *City View Homes / MRC Lots:* Closing delayed to September due to historical title issues and unreleased liens from bank mergers. Construction on infill homes (South Central, Southside, Thomas Park, Avondale) to start immediately after September 15 closing. Two additional state housing project applications submitted.
 - *Hotel Feasibility Study:* Preliminary report is very positive, indicating support for multiple hotels, recommending an east-side 55-room, four-story hotel with a pool, bar, and lounge.
 - *Budget & TIF Updates:* Detailed allocations for downtown maintenance, Southway Plaza demolition (Markets on Madison), McKinley/Ready Grant (\$500,000), and Tilpond Park (\$300,000).
 - *Parks Upgrades:* \$600,000 allocated across 10 parks (including Tuhey Pool, Skate Park at Westside Park, Ball Court Park, etc.). Detailed discussion regarding allocating \$220,000 to the Westside Park skate park to build a facility for a city of 65,000 residents.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report; no formal board action required.
- **00:30:57 Opening and Awarding of Lot Bid**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Freeman and the Mayor.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Opening of an advertised public bid for a redevelopment lot. The sole bid was submitted by Melissa J. Howell for \$35,000 cash with an earnest deposit of \$1,000, zero contingencies, intending to build an owner-occupied home on lot number 25.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion made and seconded to accept the offer. **Approved by Roll Call Vote** (Miller, Pravela, Tomlin, Wagley, and Lowe voting yes) 00:34:24.
- 00:37:16 **Deed Signatures for MRC Properties**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Presiding Officer / Staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Identification of properties with cleared titles through Indiana Title ready for deed signatures: 805 North Jefferson, 1101 North Blaine, and 1105 North Blaine (with West 9th Street pending).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Administrative action; deeds to be signed following the meeting.
- 00:37:53 **Muncie Land Bank Update**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Nate Howard, Muncie Land Bank.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reported acquiring 3 new properties (2 vacant lots, 1 with a structure) and selling 2 vacant lots (noting a variance approval through the Board of Zoning Appeals for urban farming). Four grants applied for; onboarding new property management software; drafting a job description for communications staff; and focusing a 15-month neighborhood strategy on Thomas Park, Avondale, South Central, and Industry neighborhoods.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational update; no formal vote taken.
- 00:42:01 **Innovation Connector & Certified Tech Park Funding**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Baker, Innovation Connector.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented updates on the Certified Technology Park system. Requested formal board approval to receive an upcoming \$400,000 performance-based state pass-through fund via the Redevelopment Commission. Highlighted 1,314 tech park employees averaging nearly \$67,000/year, a pending \$1 million EDA grant application to triple the size of the Innovation Connector (adding a 28,800 sq. ft. building), and announced "Entrepreneur Showcase Week" (Nov 14<U+2013>19) featuring 20 events and a tailgate celebration for ARP fund recipients.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion made and seconded to approve the transfer of funds upon receipt. **Approved by Roll Call Vote** (Miller, Pravela, Tomlin, Wagley, and Lowe voting yes) 00:51:02.
- 00:52:01 **Late Property Acquisition Proposal (Ralph Evans)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Staff / Deputy Mayor.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Late application presented for Ralph Evans (living at 1000 North Macedonia) to acquire adjacent MRC lots 1002 and 1006 North Macedonia for \$500 to maintain as green space.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion made and seconded to send the proposal to the Land Bank for review. **Approved by Roll Call Vote** (Miller, Pravela, Tomlin, Wagley, and Lowe voting yes) 00:53:26.
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Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- 00:53:54 No members of the public stepped forward for open public comment during the citizen forum.
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Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** None beyond the scheduled next meeting date.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned until **September 15, 2022** 00:53:58.
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